

Sunday, 14 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 20° 14°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 18° 12°	MANCHESTER Overcast 19° 12°	GLASGOW Overcast 20° 10°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The Royal Family gathered on the Buckingham Palace balcony today for the King's official birthday celebrations, watching the spectacular Red Arrows flypast.

Over 1,400 members of the armed forces also took part in the annual Trooping the Colour event. The King and Queen were cheered by crowds as they rode along The Mall.

ROYAL · UK
- 2

Thousands have gathered in Belfast for an anti-racism rally, following a week of violence and disorder in the city.

Protesters met at Belfast City Hall to demonstrate against recent incidents. The rally aims to promote unity and address the underlying issues.

SOCIAL AFFAIRS · UK
- 3

A charity has warned that banning social media for under-16s would be impossible to enforce.

The Molly Rose Foundation believes the focus should instead be on banning features that make platforms addictive. This comes amid ongoing debate about children's online safety.

TECHNOLOGY · UK
- 4

Rugby star Kevin Sinfield has been knighted in the latest honours list, alongside authors Malorie Blackman and Julia Donaldson who become dames.

The Noughts & Crosses author and the Gruffalo creator are recognised for their contributions to literature. Sinfield receives his knighthood for services to rugby league and motor neurone disease awareness.

HONOURS · UK
- 5

A police officer from Derbyshire has been removed from frontline duties, accused of creating AI evidence.

Derbyshire Police are investigating the allegations, which raise serious questions about the use of artificial intelligence in law enforcement. The officer's role is currently under review.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

1 Harry Styles kicked off his Wembley residency, reminiscing about his X Factor audition which took place nearby in 2010.

The pop star delighted fans with a trip down memory lane, reflecting on his early career. It's a full circle moment for the global superstar.

ON AIR – Harry Styles has come a long way since his X Factor days! What's your favourite Harry Styles song?
MUSIC · TODAY

2 Linkin Park are set to make history as the first female-fronted band to headline Download Festival.

The rock legends will top the bill at the iconic festival, marking a significant moment for the event. Fans are eagerly anticipating their performance.

ON AIR – Linkin Park making history at Download! What's your favourite Linkin Park track?
MUSIC · COMING UP

3 Australian singer and actress Delta Goodrem has been confirmed as the third celebrity joining this year's Strictly Come Dancing line-up.

Goodrem, who rose to fame in the soap opera Neighbours, will be taking to the dancefloor. She joins a growing list of stars for the new series.

ON AIR – Delta Goodrem on Strictly! Who else would you love to see join the show this year?
TV · COMING UP

4 Authors Malorie Blackman and Julia Donaldson have been made dames in the latest honours list.

The Noughts & Crosses author and the Gruffalo creator are recognised for their significant contributions to literature. It's a wonderful acknowledgement of their work.

ON AIR – Two fantastic authors made dames! What's your favourite book by Malorie Blackman or Julia Donaldson?
LITERATURE · TODAY

5 A 1978 album by Allan Taylor is finally getting overdue recognition, after Ed Sheeran discovered it in a second-hand store.

Sheeran's chance find has brought new attention to Taylor's music, decades after its original release. It's a lovely story of rediscovery.

ON AIR – A great story of an artist getting their moment in the spotlight thanks to Ed Sheeran! Have you ever found a hidden gem in a second-hand shop?
MUSIC · TODAY

On the schedule

1 **George Russell has bounced back to take pole position for the Barcelona-Catalunya Grand Prix, beating Lewis Hamilton.**

After recent disappointments, Russell delivered a strong performance in qualifying. It sets up an exciting race for the British driver.

ON AIR – A fantastic comeback for George Russell! Do you think he can convert pole into a win tomorrow?

F1 · UK

2 **Emma Raducanu has battled into the Queen's semi-finals, overcoming an injury scare, but fellow Briton Katie Boulter is out.**

Raducanu defeated Kamilla Rakhimova in a tough match. Unfortunately, Boulter's run came to an end in her semi-final.

ON AIR – Emma Raducanu through to the semis! How far do you think she can go at Queen's?

TENNIS · UK

3 **Scotland are finally back on the World Cup stage for their must-win opener, their first in 28 years.**

The team is preparing in Boston, with high hopes for their campaign. It's a momentous occasion for Scottish football fans.

ON AIR – Scotland's first World Cup match in 28 years! How excited are you for their opener?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Scotland have secured their first ever T20 World Cup win, beating Ireland by 40 runs at Old Trafford.**

It was a dominant performance from the Scottish side in their opening match. This historic victory will boost their confidence in the tournament.

ON AIR – What a win for Scotland in the T20 World Cup! Did you watch the match?

CRICKET · UK

5 **Most of England's stolen training equipment has now been recovered, ahead of their arrival in Kansas City.**

The team had some gear taken prior to their trip. Thankfully, the majority has been found, allowing them to focus on their preparations.

ON AIR – Good news that England's stolen equipment has been recovered! What's the strangest thing you've ever had stolen?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that taking a short 'mindfulness walk' can significantly boost creativity.**
Researchers found that even a ten-minute stroll, focusing on your senses, helped participants generate more innovative ideas afterwards. So, a quick wander could be the answer to writer's block!
- 2 The enduring popularity of 'retro video games' is seeing a surge, with more families gathering to play classic consoles.**
Experts believe the simple, often collaborative nature of older games offers a refreshing contrast to modern, complex titles. It's all about shared fun and nostalgia!
- 3 A recent poll revealed that 'the smell of freshly baked bread' is the most comforting scent for Brits.**
It beat out other contenders like cut grass and rain on hot pavement. There's just something about that yeasty aroma that brings a sense of home and happiness.
- 4 The trend of 'upcycling old furniture' into new, stylish pieces is transforming homes across the country.**
People are getting creative with paint, fabric, and a bit of elbow grease, giving beloved but worn items a whole new lease of life. It's good for the planet and your wallet!
- 5 A fascinating study found that houseplants can actually 'improve concentration' in home offices.**
Beyond just looking nice, the presence of greenery is thought to reduce stress and increase focus, making your workspace a little bit smarter. Time to get some leafy companions!
- 6 The simple pleasure of 'writing postcards' is experiencing a quiet revival as people seek more personal ways to connect.**
Moving away from instant messages, sending a handwritten card with a thoughtful message is becoming a cherished way to share holiday memories or just say hello. A lovely touch, isn't it?
- 7 More people are discovering the joy of 'outdoor cinema' nights, transforming gardens and parks into movie theatres under the stars.**
With projectors becoming more accessible, enjoying a favourite film al fresco with friends and family is a magical way to spend an evening. Just remember the blankets!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'rearranging' what in our kitchen cupboards, even if we're not the primary cook?

ANSWER: THE SPICE RACK! APPARENTLY, WE ALL HAVE OUR OWN PREFERRED ORDER.

Q A recent poll asked Brits what small, everyday sound instantly makes them feel productive and ready to tackle the day. What came out on top?

ANSWER: THE GENTLE HUM OF THE KETTLE BOILING FOR THAT FIRST CUP OF TEA!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you spot a particular type of bird, or a unique flower, and it just makes your day a little bit brighter?

What's the most surprising or beautiful bit of nature you've spotted recently, right on your doorstep or out and about?

- We all have those little 'traditions' we stick to, especially when the weather turns warmer, don't we?

What's one of your favourite springtime or summer traditions that you look forward to every year?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** Did you know that there are more trees on Earth than stars in the Milky Way galaxy? Current estimates suggest around 3 trillion trees compared to 100-400 billion stars.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that honey never spoils? Archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still perfectly edible today.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£22 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£22 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is known as a 'parliament'.
- The world's first public railway line, the Stockton and Darlington Railway, opened in England in 1825.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The Great Fire of London in 1666 destroyed about 80% of the city but killed very few people.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- The human eye can distinguish approximately 10 million different colours.
- There are more permutations of a standard deck of 52 cards than there are atoms on Earth.
- The 'ping' sound of a microwave oven was originally a cowbell, before being changed to a more electronic tone.

On this day

Day 165 of the year, 200 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Burchard of Meissen; Christian feast day: Caomhán of Inisheer; Christian feast day: Elisha (Roman Catholic and Lutheran); Christian feast day: Fortunatus of Naples (Roman Catholic). Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1991 — Jesy Nelson, English singer
- 1971 — Will Cullen Hart, American musician (died 2024)
- 1942 — Jonathan Raban, English author and academic (died 2023)
- 1988 — Kevin McHale, American actor, singer, dancer and radio personality
- 1959 — Marcus Miller, American bass player, composer, and producer
- 1954 — Will Patton, American actor
- 1984 — Siobhán Donaghy, English singer-songwriter
- 1936 — Renaldo Benson, American singer-songwriter (died 2005)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1994 — The 1994 Vancouver Stanley Cup riot occurs after the New York Rangers defeat the Vancouver Canucks to win the Stanley Cup, causing an estimated C\$1.1 million, leading to 200 arrests and injuries.
- 1944 — World War II: After several failed attempts, the British Army abandons Operation Perch, its plan to capture the German-occupied town of Caen.
- 1940 — World War II: The German occupation of Paris begins.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1276 — While in exile in Fuzhou, away from the advancing Mongol invaders, the remnants of the Song dynasty court hold the coronation ceremony for Emperor Duanzong.
- 1940 — Seven hundred and twenty-eight Polish political prisoners from Tarnów become the first inmates of the Auschwitz concentration camp.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1937 — Pennsylvania becomes the first (and only) state of the United States to celebrate Flag Day officially as a state holiday.
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1985 — Five member nations of the European Economic Community sign the Schengen Agreement establishing a free travel zone with no border controls.

- 1966 — The Vatican announces the abolition of the Index Librorum Prohibitorum ("index of prohibited books"), which was originally instituted in 1557.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 166 of the year, 199 days left in 2026. Today Arbor Day (Costa Rica); Christian feast day: Abraham of Clermont (or of St Cyriacus); Christian feast day: Alice (or Adelaide) of Schaerbeek; Christian feast day: Amos. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1969 — Idalis DeLeón, American singer and actress
- 1954 — Jim Belushi, American actor
- 1973 — Greg Vaughan, American actor and model
- 1941 — Harry Nilsson, American singer-songwriter (died 1994)
- 1962 — Chris Morris, English actor, satirist, director, and producer
- 1951 — Steve Walsh, American rock singer-songwriter and musician
- 1937 — Waylon Jennings, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2002)
- 1971 — Jake Busey, American actor, musician, and film producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1991 — In the Philippines, Mount Pinatubo erupts in the second largest volcanic eruption of the 20th century, killing over 800 people.
- 1826 — In the Auspicious Incident, the Janissary mutiny against Sultan Mahmud II is defeated and the Janissary corps is disbanded as a result.
- 1846 — The Oregon Treaty extends the border between the United States and British North America, established by the Treaty of 1818, westward to the Pacific Ocean.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1896 — One of the deadliest tsunamis in Japan's history kills more than 22,000 people.
- 1826 — In the Auspicious Incident, the Janissary mutiny against Sultan Mahmud II is defeated and the Janissary corps is disbanded as a result.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)